

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Too Old to Have a Baby?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 14

NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS - Changing patterns of parenthood

No.	Sentence
1	Overall, women today are having _____.
2	Two factors linked to later motherhood are better access to _____.
3	Having a baby later in life may also involve _____.
4	In many countries, women now have their first baby when they are _____.
5	A former label for mothers over 35 was considered _____ by many people.
6	Compared with women, men may remain _____ for longer.
7	Some young women in the West say they intend to have _____.

11 **What change does the researcher describe across recent decades?**

- A First births have shifted from women's thirties to much younger ages.
- B Having a first child after 30 has become common in many countries.
- C Women in every country now begin motherhood after turning 30.
- D First births have become less frequent only among women in their thirties.

12 **What distinction does the presenter make between the former label for mothers over 35 and social attitudes?**

- A It was replaced because most mothers now start having children before 35.
- B It remains in common use although social attitudes have become more positive.
- C Its meaning changed when women started having children in their thirties.
- D Its use has ended, while negative attitudes towards older mothers can remain.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **Why is the older male celebrity's later child mentioned?**
- A To illustrate men's ability to father children beyond women's usual fertile years.
 - B To show that older fathers usually have more children than younger fathers do.
 - C To explain why women's natural fertility begins to decline during their forties.
 - D To suggest that becoming a father later is common among male celebrities.
- 14 **According to the researcher, what may contribute to praise for an older father?**
- A People may admire his willingness to raise a child without a partner.
 - B People may assume he has chosen to delay his career for parenthood.
 - C People may notice that he has a considerably younger partner.
 - D People may believe he has avoided the health risks of later parenthood.
- 15 **How do the reactions in the researcher's comparison differ?**
- A Both parents tend to receive praise, but the father receives it more publicly.
 - B The older father may be congratulated, while the older mother may cause discomfort.
 - C The older father may cause concern, while the older mother may be congratulated.
 - D Both parents may make people uncomfortable, though for different reasons.
- 16 **What is the researcher's attitude to the difference in reactions?**
- A She regards it as an expected result of medical differences.
 - B She thinks it is mainly a question of the parents' exact ages.
 - C She treats it as a reaction limited to famous parents.
 - D She presents it as a problem involving gender.
- 17 **What can be concluded from the final comparison of young women in the West and women in more traditional countries?**
- A Views about having children can differ substantially between social settings.
 - B Young women in both settings are increasingly refusing motherhood.
 - C Women in traditional settings generally become mothers at younger ages.
 - D Western women tend to want children only after establishing careers.